THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

CLASS 8 ENGLISH — READING SKILL PAPER SET 02

Reading Comprehension | RBSE Board Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 40 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 20**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Section A has one factual passage with 10 questions (1 mark each).
3. Section B has one literary passage (poem or story) with 10 questions (1 mark each).
4. Write the question number before each answer.

SECTION — A (Reading Comprehension: Factual / Discursive Passage) 10 Marks

Read the passage and answer the questions.

1. *Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.* 10

Understanding the Monsoon

For most Indians, the year is divided not by the calendar but by the monsoon. The word comes from an Arabic term meaning 'season', and it describes winds that change direction at different times of the year. In summer, the land becomes much hotter than the sea. Warm air over the land rises, and cooler, moisture-filled winds rush in from the Indian Ocean to take its place. These winds carry clouds that burst into rain over the subcontinent.

The monsoon usually reaches the southern tip of Kerala in the first week of June. It then moves northward in two branches, one along the Arabian Sea and the other over the Bay of Bengal. By early July it covers most of the country, and it begins to withdraw from Rajasthan in September. The first showers bring relief from the heat, and people often speak of the lovely smell of wet earth, which is caused by a chemical released by soil bacteria.

The monsoon is the lifeline of Indian agriculture. Nearly half of our farmland has no irrigation canals or tube-wells, so crops like rice, jowar and cotton depend directly on the rain. A good monsoon fills the dams and rivers, which supply drinking water and electricity. A weak one, on the other hand, can mean drought, rising prices and anxious farmers.

Yet the monsoon also has a darker side. Heavy downpours in short periods cause floods in many parts of the country, washing away roads, houses and crops. Scientists say that changes in the climate are making the rainfall more uneven, with fewer rainy days but heavier showers. This makes it all the more important for cities to keep drains clean and for villages to build ponds that can store the extra water for the dry months.

(i) The word 'monsoon' comes from an Arabic term meaning: 1

(a) cloud **(b)** wind **(c)** rain **(d)** season

(ii) Monsoon winds blow towards the land because: 1

(a) land becomes hotter than the sea in summer **(b)** mountains pull them

(c) the sea becomes hotter **(d)** the sun moves north

(iii) The monsoon first reaches: 1

(a) Kerala **(b)** Rajasthan **(c)** Delhi **(d)** Assam

(iv) The word 'withdraw' in paragraph 2 means: 1

(a) begin **(b)** go back **(c)** increase **(d)** arrive

(v) Which of the following is mentioned as a result of a weak monsoon? 1

(a) floods **(b)** drought and rising prices

(c) cheaper crops **(d)** excess electricity

(vi) State whether True or False: The smell of wet earth comes from a chemical released by soil bacteria. 1

(vii) Name the two branches of the monsoon. 1

(viii) Why is the monsoon called the lifeline of Indian agriculture? 1

(ix) What does 'it' refer to in 'it begins to withdraw from Rajasthan' (paragraph 2)? 1

(x) What should cities and villages do to deal with uneven rainfall? 1

SECTION — B (Reading Comprehension: Literary Passage — Poem / Story) — 10 Marks

Read the text and answer the questions.

2. *Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.* 10

The Broken Kite

Arjun had been saving his pocket money for three weeks to buy the red kite that hung outside Gopal Chacha's shop. On the morning of Makar Sankranti he finally owned it. It was the finest kite in the lane, with a long tail of blue paper and a string that shone like a thread of glass.

By ten o'clock every rooftop in the neighbourhood was full of shouting children. Arjun's kite soared higher than all the others, and his heart soared with it. Then, from the next roof, a rival kite swooped in, crossed his string and, with one clean snap, sent the red kite spinning into the sky. It landed, broken and torn, in the branches of the neem tree in the courtyard of the old schoolteacher, Mr Verma.

Arjun slid down the stairs, close to tears. The gate of the courtyard was always shut, and the children whispered that Mr Verma never returned a ball that fell into his garden. Still, the kite was his, and Arjun took a deep breath and rang the bell.

Mr Verma opened the door slowly. "A red kite," he said, glancing at the tree. "I thought it looked rather magnificent as it fell." Arjun could not tell if he was joking. Then the old man brought out a ladder, climbed it with surprising ease, and carefully lifted the kite down. The paper was torn in two places and the frame was cracked.

"Come in," said Mr Verma. "I have glue, paper and sticks. In my day we made our own kites, and this one can be mended in half an hour." They sat together in the sunny courtyard, and as the old man worked, he told Arjun how he had once won the kite contest of his village. By noon the red kite flew again, a little crooked, but flying.

Arjun looked up at it. He realised that he had been afraid of the wrong thing. The gate had been closed, but the man behind it had only been waiting for someone to knock.

(i) Arjun bought the kite with: 1

(a) a prize **(b)** his father's gift
(c) his friend's money **(d)** his saved pocket money

(ii) The kite was cut by: 1

(a) a bird **(b)** the wind
(c) a branch of a tree **(d)** a rival kite from the next roof

(iii) Children whispered that Mr Verma: 1

(a) was very rich **(b)** was a kite maker
(c) lived alone in a forest **(d)** never returned things that fell into his garden

(iv) The phrase 'surprising ease' suggests that Mr Verma: 1

(a) was rude **(b)** was a stranger
(c) was in a hurry **(d)** climbed the ladder easily despite his age

(v) The story shows that: 1

(a) people may be kinder than we imagine **(b)** kites are expensive

(c) old people dislike children **(d)** pocket money should not be saved

(vi) State whether True or False: Arjun threw stones at Mr Verma's gate. If false, correct it. 1

(vii) Where did the broken kite land? 1

(viii) What did Mr Verma bring out to help Arjun? 1

(ix) Find a word in the passage that means 'splendid'. 1

(x) What did Arjun realise at the end? 1

END OF QUESTION PAPER **Total: 20 Marks**

MASTERMIND